

First vs Second Conditional

CEFR B1

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

Both talk about a condition and its result. Choose by how likely the situation is:

- 1 First conditional — real, likely future (If it rains, I'll stay home).
- 2 Second conditional — imaginary or unlikely (If I won the lottery, I'd travel).

Likely to happen → first (present + will). Imaginary or unlikely → second (past + would).

At a glance

	First conditional	Second conditional
Meaning	Real, likely future	Imaginary or unlikely
If-clause	present simple	past simple
Result	will + base verb	would + base verb
Example	If it rains, I'll stay home.	If I won, I'd travel.

Learning objectives

- Can choose between the first and second conditional based on likelihood (CEFR B1).
- Can form both: if + present + will, and if + past + would.
- Can explain that the second conditional's past form signals 'imaginary', not past time.



Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. First vs Second Conditional · CEFR B1

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. It's very likely: If I ____ time tonight, I'll call you.

- | | |
|--------------|---------------|
| A. have | B. had |
| C. will have | D. would have |

2. It's just a dream: If I ____ a castle, I'd invite everyone.

- | | |
|-------------|---------------|
| A. own | B. owned |
| C. will own | D. have owned |

3. If it rains tomorrow, we ____ the match.

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| A. cancel | B. will cancel |
| C. would cancel | D. cancelled |

4. If I ____ you, I'd take the job.

- | | |
|------------|-------------|
| A. am | B. were |
| C. will be | D. had been |

5. Which is a real, likely plan?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. If I had a day off, I'd sleep all day. | B. If I have a day off next week, I'll visit my parents. |
| C. If I were free, I'd help you. | D. If I won, I'd share the money. |

6. If she studies hard, she ____ the exam.

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| A. passes | B. will pass |
| C. would pass | D. passed |

7. Correct this: 'If I had time now, I'll help you.'

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. If I had time now, I'd help you. | B. If I have time now, I'd help you. |
| C. If I had time now, I helped you. | D. The sentence is already correct. |

8. If you ____ me tomorrow, I'll send the file.

- | | |
|---------------|----------------|
| A. email | B. emailed |
| C. will email | D. would email |

9. It's very unlikely: If I ____ the president, I would change the law.

- | | |
|------------|--------------|
| A. am | B. were |
| C. will be | D. have been |

10. Rewrite as imaginary: 'If I have money, I'll travel.' →

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A. If I had money, I'd travel. | B. If I have money, I'd travel. |
| C. If I had money, I'll travel. | D. If I would have money, I'd travel. |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **A. have** — A likely future takes the first conditional: 'If I have time'.
2. **B. owned** — An imaginary situation takes the second conditional: 'If I owned a castle'.
3. **B. will cancel** — A real future result uses 'will': 'we'll cancel the match'.
4. **B. were** — Advice uses the second conditional: 'If I were you'.
5. **B. If I have a day off next week, I'll visit my parents.** — First conditional = a real, likely plan: 'If I have a day off, I'll visit my parents'.
6. **B. will pass** — A likely result uses 'will': 'she'll pass the exam'.
7. **A. If I had time now, I'd help you.** — 'Had' signals imaginary, so the result needs 'would': 'If I had time now, I'd help you'.
8. **A. email** — A likely future takes the present simple: 'If you email me tomorrow'.
9. **B. were** — An unlikely situation takes the second conditional with 'were': 'If I were the president'.
10. **A. If I had money, I'd travel.** — The imaginary version is the second conditional: 'If I had money, I'd travel'.